

Dead code elimination is a compiler optimization technique that removes parts of the code that are never executed or whose results are never used, reducing memory usage and improving execution speed. For example, in unoptimized intermediate code:

```
i = 5
p = 10
x = i + p
y = 3
print(x)
```

the variable `y` is never used, so the compiler eliminates it, resulting in optimized code:

```
i = 5
p = 10
x = i + p
print(x)
```

In pseudocode, this might look like:

```
for each statement s:
    if result of s is never used:
        remove s
```

By removing unnecessary instructions, dead code elimination reduces CPU workload, saves memory, and improves overall program efficiency without changing the program's behavior.